12.6 Head and Neck Cancer*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Food sticks in my throat; I cannot swallow solids." **Objective** • Lost 7 kg • Coughs on thin fluids • Oropharyngeal tumor	**ACTUAL** Impaired swallowing related to tumor obstruction and treatment effects as evidenced by dysphagia and coughing with fluids.	• Nourished by a safe route, with weight holding steady.	• Arrange a swallow assessment with the speech and language therapist. • Provide the recommended texture-modified diet and thickened fluids. • Give tube feeds if ordered. • Weigh weekly; involve the dietitian.	• Met if weight is stable and eating is safe.
Subjective • "I do not want people to see my face." **Objective** • Facial appearance altered by surgery • Turns visitors away	**ACTUAL** Disrupted body image related to facial disfigurement as evidenced by avoidance of visitors and distress.	• Talks about her feelings and agrees to family visits.	• Invite her to say how she feels. • Prepare the family for the change in her appearance. • Discuss reconstructive and prosthetic options. • Refer for psychological support.	• Achieved when she accepts visitors.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Pharyngeal surgery and radiotherapy • Weak cough	**RISK** Risk for aspiration as evidenced by risk factors: impaired swallowing and altered anatomy.	• No aspiration.	• Sit her upright for every meal and for 30 minutes afterward. • Keep suction ready. • Watch for fever, coughing and chest signs.	• Outcome reached if aspiration does not occur.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [37], [55]. Full entries are listed in the References section.